

Israel- US Attack on Iran: Daily Status Update

March 19, 2026

Table of Contents

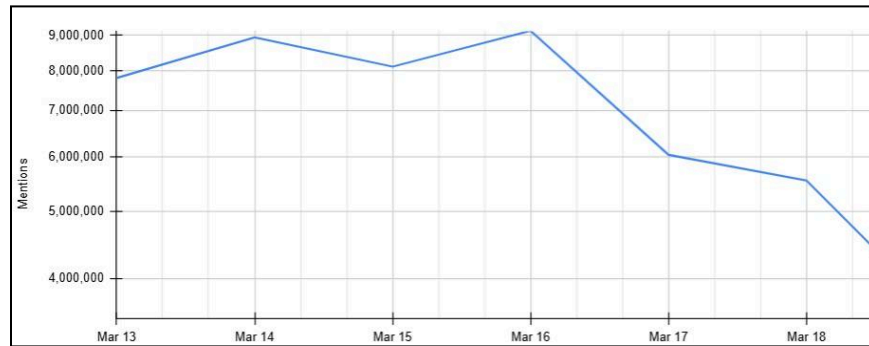
Executive Summary	3
The Ongoing Narrative of Prime Minister Netanyahu's Death	4
Top Incidents	5
Online Snapshot	6
Top Hashtags	8
Planned Protests	10
Key Statements	11
Emerging Narratives	14
Online Discourse in the Arab World	18

Executive Summary

- **The narrative claiming Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu is dead** declined significantly, with new claims (e.g., Yair Netanyahu “sitting shiva”) quickly debunked, and public clarification reinforcing that the reports are false.
- **One antisemitic incident** was identified on March 18, involving the assault of an Israeli tourist in Bangkok, Thailand.
- Online engagement reached approximately **620K X posts** on March 19.
- **330 anti-war protests** have been identified globally, primarily in the United States, including demonstrations near Israeli and American diplomatic missions.
- **International statements** focused on Iranian attacks, regional security risks, U.S. distancing from Israeli actions, and calls to protect civilian infrastructure and resume negotiations.
- **Additional narratives** include claims about a senior U.S. official’s resignation, Israeli restrictions on religious sites, a cyber breach of Israeli institutions, and unverified reports of mutiny on a U.S. naval vessel.
- **Arab-world discourse** focused on Israeli strikes, retaliation narratives, and strong negative sentiment toward Israel.

The Ongoing Narrative of Prime Minister Netanyahu's Death

- On March 18 and 19, 2026, online engagement with the narrative claiming Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's death dropped significantly.
- Attempts were made at new allegations, including **speculation regarding Yair Netanyahu's seven-day social media absence as evidence of "sitting shiva"**.
 - The theory collapsed when he resumed posting later that day, aligning with standard wartime security protocols.¹
- On March 18, 2026, Mehdi Hasan attempted to address the narrative during a live interview, which was quickly shut down as unsubstantiated on his Zeteo news platform.²



Mentions of Netanyahu's Death on X March 13-March 19



Post on X claiming that Yair Netanyahu was "sitting shiva" .



Mehdi Hasan interview explicitly saying "Netanyahu is not dead."

¹ https://x.com/The_Kremlin/status/2034125770516254790

² https://x.com/zeteo_news/status/203439532399826035

Top Incidents

Assault of Israeli Tourist in Bangkok's Khao San Area

Date: March 18, 2026

Location: Khao San area, Bangkok

On March 18, reports indicated that a young Israeli tourist was assaulted in Bangkok's Khao San area after identifying himself as Israeli to two individuals, reportedly Spanish nationals. According to the victim, the assailants attacked him with punches, kicks, and an elbow strike while shouting anti-Israel slogans. A nearby friend alerted security and assisted the victim in escaping to his hotel. Footage of the incident has circulated online, and the suspects have reportedly been arrested and are expected to face legal proceedings.³⁴

³<https://www.instagram.com/p/DWCdaVXgaza/>

⁴<https://www.instagram.com/reel/DWCFwq3DR3c/>

Online Snapshot

Number of X Posts on the 20th day of
Israel–U.S. Attack on Iran

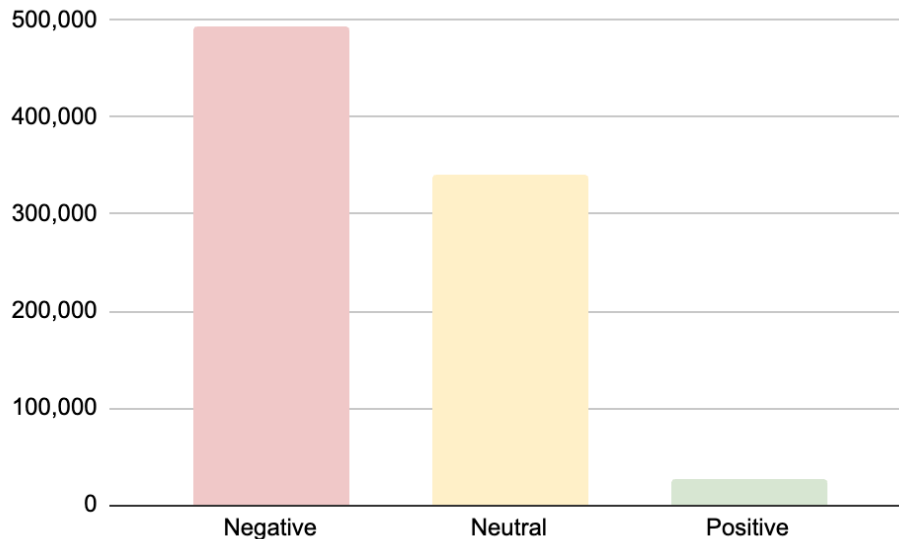
859K

(March 19)

Number of X Posts on the 20th day of Israel
Attack on Iran in June, 2025

33.8K

(July 2)



Sentiment distribution of X posts about the Israel–U.S. attack on Iran (March 19, 2026), segmented by positive, negative, and neutral mentions

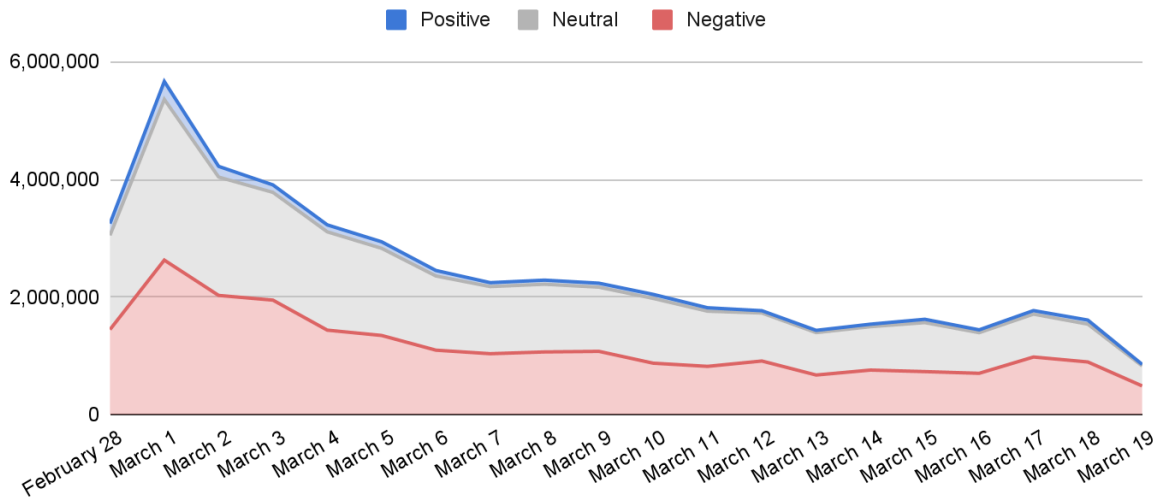
Positive mentions

- Political and alliance narratives highlight global support for anti-war positions, strengthening ties between Israel and Gulf states, and emerging alignment among smaller allies with the U.S.
- Military and strategic narratives emphasize Iran's adaptive use of missiles and drones, ongoing strikes on energy and military targets, and continued regional escalation.
- Public and economic narratives reflect mixed global support for different sides, domestic backing within Iran, and rising energy market volatility driven by attacks on key infrastructure.

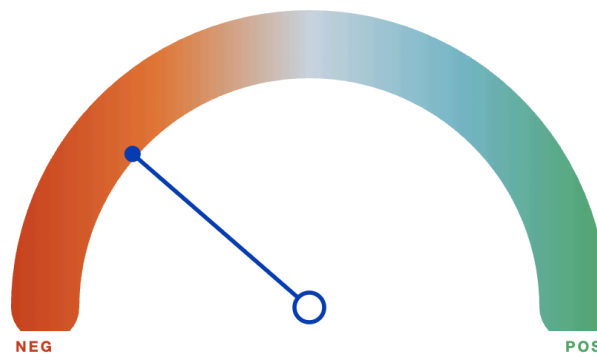
Negative mentions

- Coordination narratives claim the U.S. prioritized war over diplomacy, coordinated strikes with Israel, and was pressured into the conflict by Israeli influence.

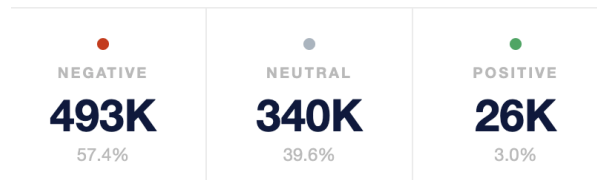
- Escalation narratives highlight Iranian retaliation against Gulf states, damage to critical energy infrastructure, and continued strikes on U.S. and regional targets.
- Geopolitical narratives emphasize failed diplomacy, declining U.S. influence, and growing instability benefiting rival powers such as Russia and China.



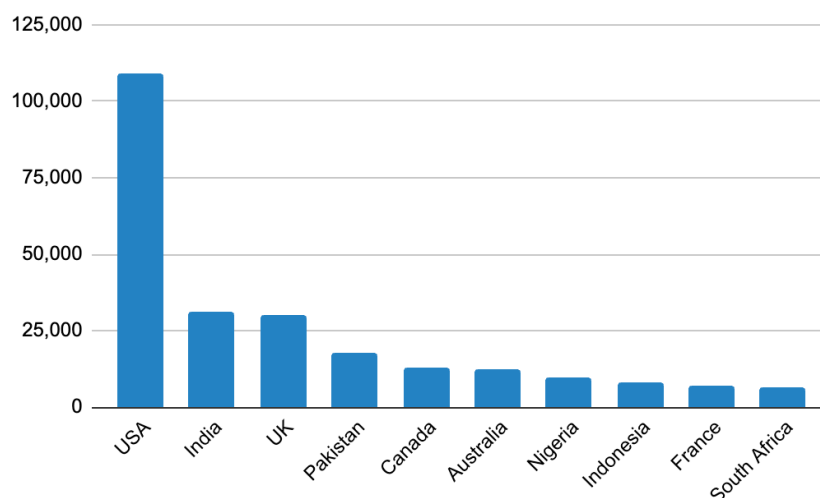
This graph displays the volume of positive, neutral, and negative X posts related to the Israel-U.S. attack on Iran between February 28 and March 19.



858,900
mentions



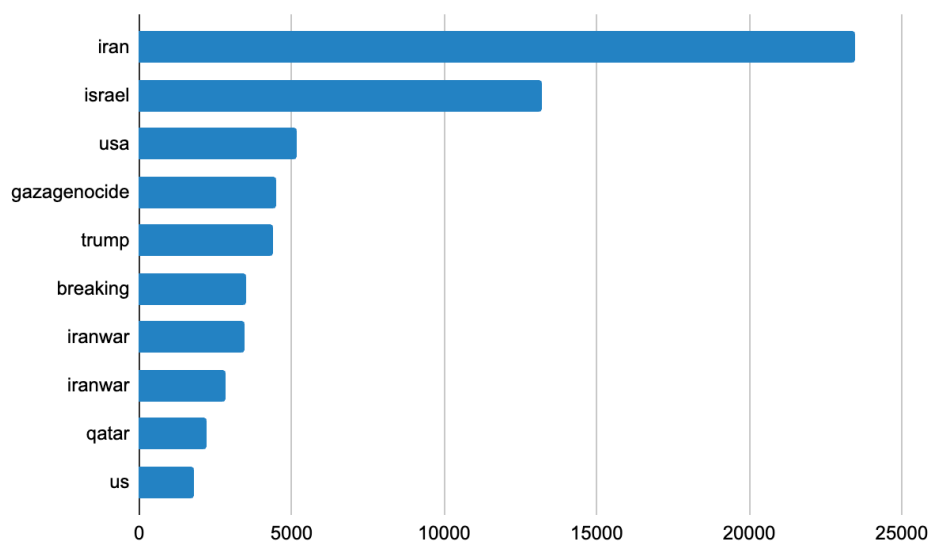
Sentiment Monitor (March 19, 2026)



Top countries by volume of X posts about the Israel-U.S. attack on Iran (March 19, 2026)

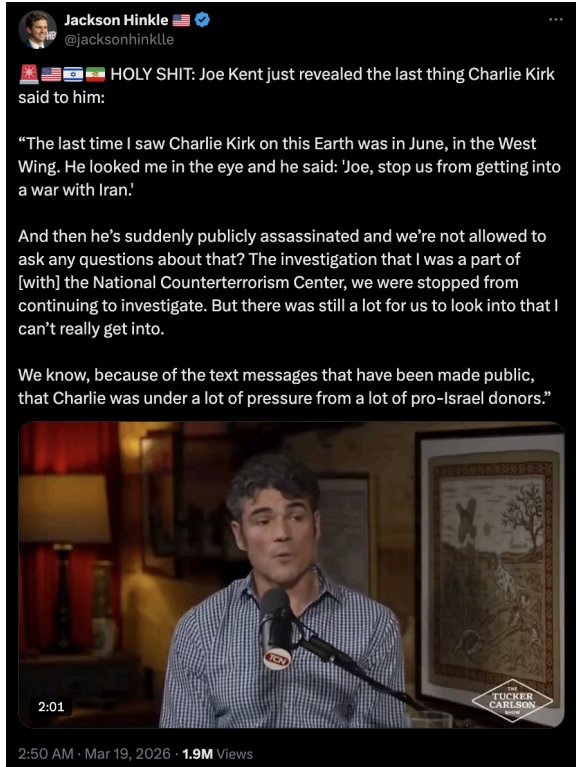
Top Hashtags

- Hashtags are keywords used on social media to organize conversations and make posts easier to find.
- The most common hashtags in posts about the Israel-U.S. attack on Iran (e.g., #iran, #israel, #iranwar, #usa) mainly serve as basic descriptors of the conflict and help users join broader discussions about the war, rather than indicating specific narratives or coordinated messaging.

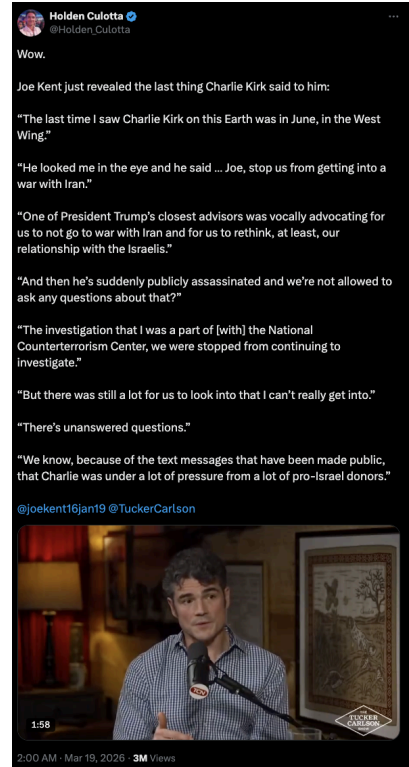


Top hashtags used in X posts discussing the Israel-U.S. attack on Iran (March 19, 2026), ranked by volume

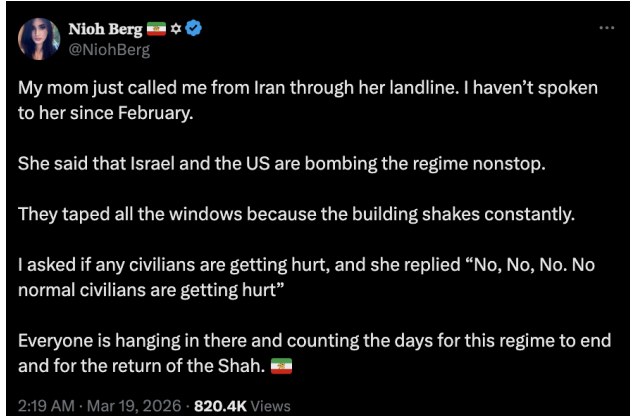
Top Posts on X



Post claiming U.S. officials were pressured by pro-Israel actors to enter war with Iran, citing statements attributed to Joe Kent and Charlie Kirk.



Narrative suggesting suppressed investigations and political pressure influenced U.S. decision-making on the Iran conflict.



Personal account describing ongoing airstrikes in Iran, portraying continuous bombing and civilian conditions under conflict.



Claim that Iran offered concessions during negotiations, framed as evidence that the U.S. chose escalation over diplomacy.

⁵ <https://x.com/jacksonhinkle/status/2034432261848694802>

⁶ https://x.com/Holden_Culotta/status/2034419794099777620

⁷ <https://x.com/NiohBerg/status/2034424419075133631>

⁸ <https://x.com/FurkanGozukara/status/2034396587019895078>

Planned Protests

- To date, **approximately 330 protests opposing the war in Iran have been identified worldwide**, the majority of which are taking place in the **United States**. Several of these demonstrations are planned in **close proximity to Israeli and American diplomatic missions**. As the conflict continues, further protests are likely to be announced.
- As of March 19, approximately **50 protests** are expected to take place worldwide in the coming days.



Post promoting upcoming anti-Israel protest in Athens

Key Statements

 Saudi Arabia	
Name	Faisal bin Farhan Al Saud, Minister of State for Foreign Affairs of Saudi Arabia
Date	March 19, 2026
Online Exposure	Not available (source: news article)
Statement	“The level of accuracy in some of this targeting – you can see it in our neighbours as well as the kingdom – indicates that this is something that was premeditated, preplanned, preorganised and well thought out. I’m not going to lay out what would and would not precipitate a defensive action by the Kingdom [of Saudi Arabia] because I think that is not a wise approach to signal to the Iranians. But I think it’s important for the Iranians to understand that the kingdom, but also its partners who have been attacked and beyond, have very significant capacities and capabilities that they could bring to bear should they choose to do so... I would hope they understand the message of the meeting today and recalculate quickly and stop attacking their neighbours. But I am doubtful they have that wisdom.”⁹
 USA	
Name	Donald Trump, President of the United States
Date	March 19, 2026
Online Exposure	Not available (source: news article)
Statement	“Israel, out of anger for what has taken place in the Middle East, has violently lashed out at a major facility known as South Pars Gas Field in Iran. The United States knew nothing about this particular attack. Unfortunately, Iran did not know this, or any of the pertinent facts pertaining to the South Pars attack, and unjustifiably and unfairly attacked a portion of Qatar’s LNG Gas facility”.¹⁰

⁹<https://www.aljazeera.com/news/2026/3/19/saudi-fm-warns-iran-that-patience-in-gulf-not-unlimited-amid-attacks>

¹⁰<https://edition.cnn.com/world/live-news/iran-war-us-israel-trump-03-18-26?post-id=cmmwv6eop00003b6sslrnbn5n>

 UN	
Name	Rafael Grossi, Director General of the International Atomic Energy Agency
Date	March 18, 2026
Online Exposure	Not available (source: news article)
Statement	“This program is a very vast program... At the end of this ... the material will still be there, the enrichment capacities will be there. We will have to go back to some form of negotiation. Our assumption is that the material is ... where it was”. ¹¹

 USA	
Name	Tulsi Gabbard, Director of National Intelligence
Date	March 18, 2026
Online Exposure	Not available (source: news article)
Statement	“The only person who can determine what is and is not an imminent threat is the president. It is not the intelligence community’s responsibility to determine what is and is not an imminent threat. That is up to the president, based on the volume of information that he receives.” ¹²

 UAE	
Name	Office of the UAE Minister of Foreign Affairs
Date	March 19, 2026
Online Exposure	1.3K views
Statement	“Abdullah bin Zayed Strongly Condemns Unprovoked and Terrorist Iranian Missile Attack on West Bank in Call with Hussein Al-Sheikh. His Highness Sheikh Abdullah bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Foreign Affairs, in a phone call with His Excellency Hussein Al Sheikh,

¹¹<https://www.foxnews.com/politics/strikes-may-set-iran-back-likely-wont-end-nuclear-program-un-watchdog-chief-says>

¹²<https://www.independent.co.uk/news/world/americas/us-politics/tulsi-gabbard-iran-threat-nuclear-ossoff-b2941413.html>

Vice President of the State of Palestine, strongly condemned the unprovoked and terrorist Iranian missile attack targeting the West Bank, which resulted in several civilian casualties and injuries.

His Highness extended his sincere condolences to the Palestinian people over the victims of these terrorist attacks, and expressed his wishes for the swift recovery of all those injured.”¹³

France

Name Emmanuel Macron, President of France

Date March 18, 2026

Online Exposure 2.8M views

Statement “I have just spoken with the Emir of Qatar and President Trump following the strikes that hit gas production facilities in Iran and Qatar today. It is in our common interest to implement, without delay, a moratorium on strikes targeting civilian infrastructure, particularly energy and water supply facilities. Civilian populations and their essential needs, as well as the security of energy supplies, must be protected from military escalation.”¹⁴

¹³<https://x.com/OFMUAE/status/2034425088918098079>

¹⁴<https://x.com/EmmanuelMacron/status/2034406457446170884>

Emerging Narratives

- Over the past 24 hours, some prominent antisemitic and anti-Israel narratives have been identified in online discourse surrounding the war with Iran:

"Joe Kent: Resignation & Allegations" Narrative

Narrative	This narrative follows the high-profile resignation of Joe Kent, Director of the National Counterterrorism Center (NCTC), on March 17, 2026. Following his departure, Kent appeared in a lengthy interview on The Tucker Carlson Show on March 18, 2026, where he challenged the administration's justification for the war with Iran and raised questions regarding the 2025 assassination of conservative activist Charlie Kirk. ^{15 16}
Examples	

"Old City Access: Holy Site Closures" Narrative

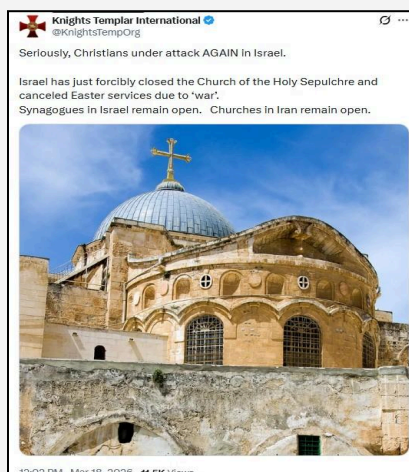
Narrative	This narrative, which intensified on March 17, 2026, reports that Israeli authorities have implemented a full closure of the Al-Aqsa Mosque and the Church of the Holy Sepulchre. The messaging presents these measures as a selective suspension of
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¹⁵ <https://x.com/TuckerCarlson/status/2034444911521513660>

¹⁶ <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1cbw1utqzHg>

religious rights, noting that they occurred during the final days of Ramadan and the lead-up to Easter. Various reports and social media accounts highlight that while restrictions are in place for these sites, other areas of Jerusalem remain active, suggesting a policy of "security-based" discrimination. This narrative serves to consolidate regional opposition and has prompted formal condemnations from the United Nations, the Arab League, and a coalition of eight Muslim-majority nations.^{17 18}

Examples



19

The "Mossad & INSS: Handala Cyber Breach" Narrative

Narrative

This narrative, launched by the pro-regime hacker collective Handala on March 17, 2026, claims to have executed a catastrophic dual cyber-attack against the Mossad and the Institute for National Security Studies (INSS). The messaging asserts that the group breached the email systems of Ilan Steiner, identifying him as the former Budget Director of Mossad and current CFO of Israel's National Security Council, while simultaneously infiltrating the servers of the INSS, a premier Israeli strategic think tank.

To support this, Handala claims to have exfiltrated 50,000 confidential documents and emails that allegedly expose "clandestine projects," financial conduits for "insider groups," and high-level strategic memos detailing methods to destabilize West Asia.²⁰

¹⁷ https://x.com/Mott_Mason/status/2034429380097642600

¹⁸ <https://x.com/MarioNawfal/status/2034233629673480615>

¹⁹ <https://x.com/IhabHassane/status/2034310874853245208/photo/1>

²⁰ <https://cybernews.com/security/handala-ex-mossad-research-head-emails-leaked-stryker-contained/>

Example



The "USS Ford: Mutiny & Sabotage" Narrative

Narrative

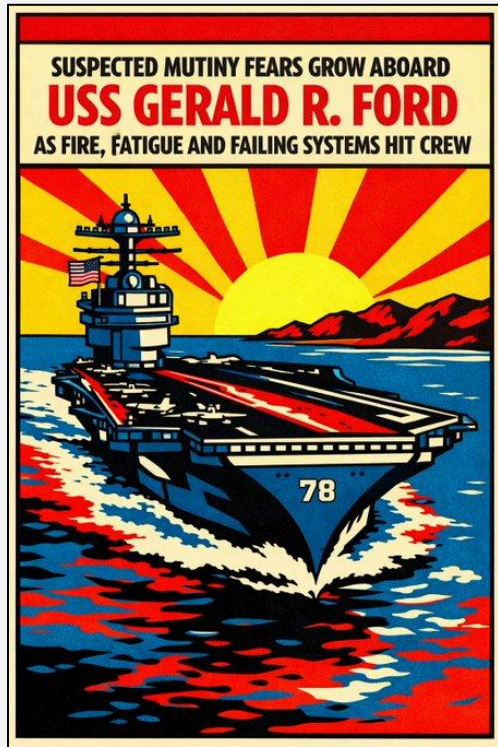
This narrative, which began circulating on March 17, 2026, claims that a "mutiny" has broken out among the crew of the USS Gerald R. Ford currently deployed in the Red Sea. The messaging suggests that a massive fire on board was not an accident but a deliberate act of sabotage by sailors protesting the ongoing war with Iran. To support this, various accounts are sharing reports of hundreds of injured sailors and claiming that the crew has effectively "seized control" of the vessel, forcing it to retreat to Crete.^{21 22 23}

²¹<https://www.facebook.com/groups/37881325571/posts/10165323157580572/>

²² <https://twitter.com/jacksonhinkle/statuses/2034408249617748042>

²³ <https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/c0rjr28nxrwo>

Example



24

BREAKING: Did Sailors Aboard The USS Gerald Ford Sabotage "Operation Epstein Fury" By Starting A MASSIVE Fire On Board?

The USS Gerald R. Ford is diverting to Crete after a 30-hour fire left 600 sailors without beds. The Navy is now investigating whether someone deliberately set it. I believe that's called "Mutiny."



DEAN BLUNDELL
MAR 18, 2026

25

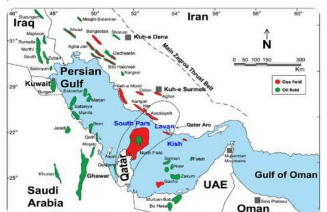
²⁴ [https://x\[.\]com/FelastoryMedia/status/2034207796078457152](https://x[.]com/FelastoryMedia/status/2034207796078457152)

²⁵ [https://deanblundell.substack\[.\]com/p/breaking-did-sailors-aboard-the-uss](https://deanblundell.substack[.]com/p/breaking-did-sailors-aboard-the-uss)

Online Discourse in the Arab World

- Discussions highlight Israeli strikes on the Pars gas field, alongside threats of retaliation against GCC oil and gas infrastructure, raising concerns over regional energy security.
- Many posts emphasize retaliatory dynamics, including missile strikes targeting Israeli interests, reflecting narratives of escalating regional confrontation.
- Widespread online content reports Israeli strikes on civilian areas in Beirut and southern Lebanon, sharing claims of casualties, infrastructure damage, and displacement.
- Some discussions focus on “resistance” narratives and ongoing military engagement against Israel, while characterizing Israeli strikes as terrorism and accusing deliberate targeting of residential areas.
- Commentary frames Israel’s military campaigns as a repeated and normalized pattern, described in highly negative terms and linked to ongoing humanitarian crises.
- Social media sentiment remains strongly negative toward Israel, with frequent use of harsh rhetoric condemning Zionism and Israeli actions.

Examples:

Get ready you all; the Jewish Empire just committed suicide on behalf of all the "west" & GCC by attacking Pars Gas field, the largest in the world and jointly managed by Iran & Qatar. The IIRGC just announced it will retaliate by destroying all the Oil/Gas Infrastructure in the Vessels around it. All countries in North Africa, West Asia & South Asia are already feeling the effects of the attack on Pars; with most of them heavily dependent on its gas for regular life needs, from Turkey to India and every country in between. Now imagine in the next few hours, as all the GCC and Zionist Colony gas/oil fields go up in flames? Let the whole world come to its knees; either Humanity comes and takes the Jewish Colony garbage back to Europe; or all of humanity will live the same life we have been living in West Asia for the past one hundred years.  Post on Israeli strikes on the Pars gas field, raising concerns over regional energy security²⁶	Hadi Hattel هادي حطيط @HadiHtt Israeli terrorists started destroying entire buildings in west Beirut now.  Hadi Hattel هادي حطيط @HadiHtt - Mar 19 Israeli strike on Baachoura, west Beirut, right on morning prayer time. 3rd location in west Beirut targeted today without any military significance. Pure terrorism to intimidate the people and pressure the resistance and its leadership to surrender. Signs of ISR bankruptcy! Post claiming Israeli attacks in Beirut are deliberately targeting of residential areas²⁷	Faizaan Unscripted @FaizUnscripted USA & Israel are together responsible for a million killed in Iraq, thousands in Afghanistan, thousands in Syria, Libya, Gaza and in a lot more countries.. Not to mention that Israel just bombed little kids in Iran too. And on the top of that trump is mentioned in the Epstein's files, and he's used little kids for terrible reasons, Epstein was a Zionist and these people worship Baal, the Iranians destroyed the statue of Baal, what did you expect was gonna happen to them anyway after destroying the statue. These people are devils, they're not the peacemakers you think they are. They worship satan... Posts on Social media are strongly negative toward Israel²⁸
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²⁶ <https://x.com/TVFreePalestine/status/2034293474455953854>

²⁷ <https://x.com/HadiHtt/status/203411658499449149>

²⁸ <https://x.com/FaizUnscripted/status/2034150171504996612>